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Culture (OWC): [Tonga \(FQ12\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1946-1947, 1948, 1950

Coverage Date: 1945-1951

Place Coverage

northeast-central Southern province, Zambia

Section Title(S): CASE XII: PARENTAL CONTROL OF MARRIAGE

Marriage into the father's clan, or into the clan of either grandfather, or into a clan in a joking relationship with one's own clan, was considered highly desirable, since existing relationships gave a claim over and beyond that of the affinal tie, and this might be appealed to in an emergency. Today when such considerations are no longer to the fore, people commonly talk in terms of kinship rather than clan relationships when they discuss marriage preferences.

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There was a preference for marriage with those to whom some types of relationship could be traced, though today these relationships are becoming of less importance. Firm prohibitions banned marriages with other kinsmen, and many of these prohibitions are still observed.

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All marriage or sexual intercourse is prohibited between brothers and sisters, whether or not they be of the same matrilineal group. Paternal half-siblings, paternal parallel cousins, and the children of any two men of the same matrilineal group who call one another 'brother' are thus forbidden to marry. I think that if the two fathers are only very remotely related a marriage might eventually be accepted though there is still a feeling that it is disreputable. The children of paternal half-brothers would probably not be permitted to marry, and I have recorded no instance of such a marriage. Maternal half-siblings and maternal parallel cousins are forbidden to marry, but these

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marriages are also under the ban of clan exogamy. What this rule does in effect is to prevent either the *basimukowa* or the same generation of the *basyanausi* appearing in two roles within a single household.

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Marriage or sexual relations between father and daughter, and between mother and son, are considered incestuous. This applies equally to classificatory relationships, but I am not certain how far the classification is carried as a bar to marriage. In one instance a man's successor was the paternal half-sister's son of the dead man's wife. He wished to inherit her, and apparently found some support for the scheme among his matrilineal kin. The woman refused, saying it was unthinkable for her to marry her 'son'. In this case it is possible to speak of succession occurring without the inheritance of the wife, for the man succeeded to an official title and not to the dead man's household. In other instances people  322 who have stood in a 'father-daughter' or a 'mother-son' relationship because of the classification together of alternate generations have pressed a marriage against the wishes of their kinsmen, and finally succeeded in carrying their point. Two instances of such irregular marriages occur in Chart I. In one case a man had married his mother's mother's brother's daughter, who ranked as his 'daughter'; in the other, he had married his father's sister's daughter's daughter, who ranked as his 'mother' or 'father's sister'. Both marriages are definitely irregular and were fought by the older people, but either they were not considered incestuous or the old scandal had disappeared by the time I knew the people involved. Both marriages were in the Nampeyo neighbourhood.

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